

May 8, 2026

Meeting May 8, 2026 at 16:34

BST

Meeting records  Transcript

Summary

Meeting reviewed technical application bugs and aligned on a new UK-focused university launch strategy.

Technical Bug Assessment

Testing identified significant image upload, email verification, and onboarding flow errors. The team decided to prioritize Android and device-specific simulation to stabilize these core features.

Strategic Launch Shift

The project will pivot to a niche launch in Sheffield universities to ensure stability and growth. This strategy minimizes legal risks while building a foundational user base.

Monetization and Operations

The team established a future subscription and advertisement model for business outreach. Future expansion plans include ticket sales and community organization integration for long-term revenue.

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Decisions

We've **updated the Decisions section** using your feedback.

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ALIGNED

- **Registration requires name and profile name** The registration process will be updated to require a first and last name for backend records, with an additional separate field added for a user-facing profile name.
- **100km event discovery radius limit** The event discovery feature will be configured to limit search results to a 100-kilometer radius from the user's location, with events outside this range relegated to a secondary display section.
- **Waitlist CTA buttons linked to signup** All call-to-action buttons, including 'Join Waitlist', 'Coming Soon', and the bottom navigation tab, will be linked to navigate directly to the signup form.
- **Staged platform rollout strategy** The platform launch strategy will prioritize onboarding businesses to post content before opening the service to general users.
- **Business monetization framework** Businesses will be granted a one-month free trial period, after which they must select from paid subscription or per-post models.
- **Market focus pivot** The project target market is officially pivoted back to focusing on the Sheffield student population and local niche organizations.

Next steps

- ☐ [Ryan Lind] Fix Email Bugs: Investigate why verification emails go to junk/spam folders. Ensure the verify email address button is consistently displayed in clients like Outlook/Hotmail.
- ☐ [Ryan Lind] Improve Email Link: Shorten and refine the appearance of the verification link included in the welcome email template.

- ☐ [Ryan Lind] Purchase Test Phone: Buy a similar, slightly older Android device (e.g., S21 or comparable model) via Facebook for dedicated app testing.
- ☐ [Ryan Lind] Fix Tooltips: Modify onboarding logic to prevent tooltips from appearing after the user account has reached the verified section.
- ☐ [Ryan Lind] Debug Samsung Upload: Simulate the Samsung Android device locally to replicate image and document upload failures reported by Thameena Majeed.
- ☐ [Ryan Lind] Update Profile Flow: Capture the users first and last name during sign-up and automatically set that data as the default profile name.
- ☐ [Ryan Lind] Fix About Prompt: Update the About You onboarding section prompt to dynamically include the user's first name.
- ☐ [Ryan Lind] Fix Interruption Skip: Investigate and resolve the bug where external interruptions (calls, texts) cause the user to skip the remainder of the onboarding flow.
- ☐ [Ryan Lind] Filter Events: Implement location filtering logic to limit event visibility to a 100 kilometer radius once location services are enabled.
- ☐ [Ryan Lind] Send Contact Details: Provide Amy's contact details and information regarding her growth marketing business, Born Digital, to Thameena Majeed.
- ☐ [Ryan Lind] Delete Test Account: Remove the test email account linkshotmail.com used by Thameena Majeed today from the database.
- ☐ [Ryan Lind] Create Demo Video: Produce a 30-second promotional video demonstrating a quick rundown of app functionality, including event filtering.
- ☐ [Ryan Lind] Fix Waitlist Links: Ensure all three text elements (Early Access, Coming Soon, bottom tab) on the waitlist page are clickable and link directly to the sign-up form.
- ☐ [Ryan Lind] Fix Waitlist Error: Resolve the row level error causing the Something went wrong message when users attempt to submit their details to join the waitlist.
- ☐ [Thameena Majeed] Contact Businesses: Contact organizations and businesses in Sheffield to bulk out the database and direct them to the working waitlist registration page.
- ☐ [Ryan Lind] Attach Links: Attach the social media links provided by Esen to the waitlist welcome email template. Ensure links are working and clickable for users.
- ☐ [Thameena Majeed] Prepare Business Email: Draft and send an email to businesses notifying them they can post events when the app is ready. Offer 1 month of free posting to incentivize early adoption.

- ☐ [Ryan Lind] Delete Accounts: Delete every user and business account currently associated with Thameena Majeed's login information.

Details

- **Initial Check-in and Technical Issues Overview:** Ryan Lind and Thameena Majeed began the meeting by apologizing for the chaotic scheduling and noting the time difference. Thameena Majeed reported having time to go through the app and identified several issues, including creating a new user account, which resulted in the app skipping the entire onboarding process after a short call interruption and leading directly to the location step ([00:00:00](#)) ([00:37:22](#)).
- **Image Upload Issues for General User Profile:** Thameena Majeed detailed difficulties with image uploads, initially being unable to upload an image, then succeeding after four or five attempts, but later being unable to upload a different image or revert to the original one. They confirmed they were testing as a general user, not a business ID, because the business ID verification page was inaccessible ([00:01:40](#)).
- **Confirmation of Image Upload Problems by Another Tester:** Thameena Majeed noted that Danny, another tester, experienced the same image upload issue ([00:02:26](#)). Ryan Lind confirmed that Danny had reported a different error related to logging in with an old app build that showed a "coming soon" login feature, which has since been fixed by making the update automatic ([00:03:26](#)).
- **Previous Functionality of Image Uploads:** Thameena Majeed confirmed that image uploads were successful in previous updates, noting that both their initial user profile and friends' test profiles were able to upload pictures. The issues are recent and seem to be related to the recent updates ([00:04:29](#)).
- **Device Compatibility Concerns:** Ryan Lind expressed confusion about the inconsistency of the bug since the system is designed to handle various image types and securely upload them ([00:04:29](#)). Thameena Majeed is using a Samsung S21 phone, which is not an ancient device ([00:06:16](#)).
- **Addressing Perceived Acrimony in Communication:** Thameena Majeed acknowledged that their messages might seem abrupt when reporting errors but reassured Ryan Lind that they understand and believe they are working to fix the issues. They emphasized the importance of addressing bugs like the

image upload problem, as it will be experienced by other users, especially international ones ([00:07:01](#)).

- **Proposal for Step-by-Step Testing Session:** Ryan Lind proposed a step-by-step walkthrough during the call to replicate the errors, using an up-to-date iPhone simulator ([00:03:26](#)) ([00:07:48](#)). They decided to start with the business sign-up flow first, as Thameena Majeed could not get past the verification process ([00:08:33](#)).
- **Confirmation Email Issues (Business Flow):** During the business sign-up walkthrough, Ryan Lind noted the need for an EU cookie banner ([00:08:33](#)). Thameena Majeed highlighted two critical issues with the email confirmation process: the email often goes to the junk folder, and the verification email is missing the required button, showing only a link ([00:09:21](#)).
- **Developer View vs. User View Discrepancy:** Ryan Lind was surprised by the missing button, as their screenshot showed the "Verify Email Address" button ([00:11:08](#)). Thameena Majeed, who uses a Hotmail/Outlook account, confirmed that the button is absent, which illustrates the difficulty of testing across different devices and clients. Ryan Lind agreed to look into the Outlook client issue ([00:11:54](#)).
- **Image Upload and Replacement (Business Flow):** Thameena Majeed reiterated issues with image uploads on their Samsung device, noting that although a success message appears, the image does not upload until they refresh the page, which still takes multiple attempts. They added that replacing uploaded ID documents is also not possible on their phone ([00:17:32](#)).
- **Hypothesizing Device Specific Issues:** Ryan Lind suspected the issues might be specific to Samsung or Android and committed to setting up an Android simulation to replicate the bugs. They ruled out server-side issues (such as Bahrain connectivity) as unlikely causes ([00:18:40](#)).
- **Skipped Onboarding Pop-ups:** Thameena Majeed reported that they did not receive the expected pop-ups for updating the app or prompts to add the app to the home screen for either the business or general user flows. Ryan Lind confirmed that the installation link should be visible ([00:20:40](#)).
- **Impact of Onboarding Issues on Testing:** Thameena Majeed explained that the onboarding issues prevent them from setting up their business profile and fully testing features like the rating system. They stressed the need to resolve the Samsung onboarding situation for the rest of the application to function correctly ([00:21:32](#)).

- **Mandatory Profile Name Requirement (Personal Flow):** Transitioning to the personal flow, Thameena Majeed requested making a profile name compulsory, as some testers skipped it, resulting in a blank display ([00:22:27](#)). They suggested using the first and last name collected during sign-up as the profile name to mitigate the issue of multiple users having the same generic name ([00:23:13](#)).
- **Review of Data Collection and Moderation:** The discussion confirmed the necessity of collecting real names (first and last name) for legal records and data purposes ([00:24:51](#)). The profile name, which should be based on the provided name, would fall under the existing moderation discussions concerning inappropriate language, similar to handling comments ([00:23:13](#)).
- **Discussion of Colleague's Workload:** Thameena Majeed provided an update on Danny's workload, who is overwhelmed with preparing five different departmental portfolios due to the lack of Middle East exams ([00:26:29](#)). The complexity of remote student monitoring and international time zones for schoolwork was discussed ([00:27:22](#)).
- **Efficacy of Portfolio Work vs. Exams:** Thameena Majeed asserted that portfolio work leads to better student results than traditional exams, which they characterized as mentally draining memory tests ([00:29:04](#)). They noted that predictive grading during COVID-19 resulted in the best GCSE results in 25 years ([00:30:42](#)).
- **Consolidated List of Bugs to Address:** Thameena Majeed summarized the key bugs identified with the limited movement they had: image upload issues (both user and business), emails going to junk, the missing verification button, the absence of the add-to-home-screen pop-up, and location feature inconsistencies ([00:43:53](#)).
- **Location Filtering Strategy:** Thameena Majeed proposed limiting initial event visibility to within 100 kilometers once location is enabled to ensure relevance for users. They suggested displaying further-away events below the local ones to avoid the app appearing empty ([00:44:49](#)).
- **New Launch Strategy Focus: UK Universities:** Thameena Majeed outlined a new launch strategy, inspired by Facebook, focusing on university students due to their tech-savviness and availability ([00:45:42](#)). They plan to launch in Sheffield first, which has a large, year-round international student population ([00:46:27](#)).
- **Strategic Advantages of UK Launch:** Launching in the UK provides a safer legal environment, avoiding strict slander and criticism laws found in GCC countries ([00:48:30](#)). The goal is to start small, gather reliable data, and

organically grow, with Manchester being the next target city ([00:47:36](#)) ([00:50:40](#)).

- **Request for Marketing Support:** Thameena Majeed requested a referral for someone to manage social media (Instagram and TikTok) and content creation before contacting businesses. Ryan Lind recommended a freelancer named Amy from Born Digital, who specializes in growth marketing ([00:52:32](#)).
- **Pre-Marketing Task and Weight List Issues:** Thameena Majeed preferred to wait for some of the bugs to be sorted before contacting the marketer so the app is stable for testing ([00:54:08](#)). They also requested short video content demonstrating the app's functions ([00:54:53](#)). The meeting concluded with the identification of an error when users attempt to sign up for the wait list ([00:56:26](#)).
- **Weight List and Business Outreach:** Thameena Majeed intends to contact businesses to bulk out the database, which requires a working waitlist page that triggers a welcome email. Ryan Lind confirmed the welcome email is triggered, and Thameena Majeed requested that links to social media handles, which Esen provided, be attached to the waitlist email so users can easily follow their pages ([00:58:04](#)). Thameena Majeed emphasized the need for a working website to allow organizations like the student union in Sheffield to join the waitlist ([00:59:01](#)).
- **Marketing Strategy and Timeline:** Thameena Majeed plans to work on social media and marketing materials the following day and anticipates having a working waitlist within the next three to four days. Ryan Lind agreed to address the waitlist issues as soon as possible (ASAP), noting that targeting a niche audience is the correct approach to ensure the idea spreads quickly. The strategy involves balancing outreach to businesses and general users by figuring out the appropriate marketing budget allocation ([00:59:48](#)).
- **Onboarding Businesses and General Users:** The initial plan is to give businesses a day to log on, post offers, and events once the application is ready and moved to link.live, provided there is sufficient interest from the waitlist. After the businesses have an opportunity to bulk out the platform with events, the platform will then be opened up to general users ([01:00:38](#)). The content will come from various organizations, including non-traditional businesses such as Age Concern, McMillan Cancer Mornings, toddler groups, rambling groups, and gyms, to capture overlooked community events ([01:01:32](#)).
- **Targeting Overlooked Community Organizations:** Thameena Majeed clarified that their target audience extends beyond traditional businesses to include

small organizations and groups that lack an active online presence, like forest activities, tutors, and local litter picking groups ([01:02:22](#)). The goal is to provide a platform for events that would normally be advertised via physical posters or small local newsletters, reaching people who would not actively search for these groups online ([01:04:21](#)). Thameena Majeed indicated that the platform, link, is designed to be the modern replacement for physical posters on lampposts ([01:06:09](#)).

- **Geographic Focus and Legal Considerations:** The strategy involves starting with a small niche market, specifically the student population in Sheffield, and then allowing the platform to grow organically worldwide ([01:14:21](#)). Thameena Majeed prefers basing the company in the UK to provide a safety net against strict laws concerning public criticism and slander found in the GCC countries ([01:06:09](#)). Ryan Lind noted that a UK-based company would entail paying taxes in the UK once revenue is generated ([01:07:50](#)).
- **Monetization Strategy:** The monetization plan involves giving businesses one month of free posting once the platform is ready for organizations to join ([01:07:50](#)). After the free month, payment options will be introduced, such as a subscription model for a set number of posts or a pay-per-post option ([01:08:51](#)). The main source of revenue is anticipated to be through selling advertisements that run along the bottom or side of the application, similar to other major social platforms ([01:09:49](#)).
- **Future Revenue Streams and Growth:** The team intends to flip to monetization as quickly as possible once businesses are engaging with users, though the timeline is dependent on achieving significant size ([01:11:47](#)). Future revenue avenues include adding features like the ability to buy tickets for local events such as theater or snooker tickets, from which the platform would take a commission. The growth of the site will depend on continually adding new features and reaching a wide enough audience ([01:12:33](#)).
- **Account Management and Next Steps:** Ryan Lind committed to continuing work on the platform and sending updates, suggesting they will correspond over the weekend. Thameena Majeed requested that Ryan Lind delete all of their existing accounts, including the business login, so they can start from scratch and test the new experience once the changes and bug fixes have been implemented ([01:15:03](#)).

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